

Jay (Xinkai) Zou

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Education Background

University of California, San Diego	2025.9 – 2027
Master of Science, Computer Science (GPA: 3.95/4.0)	California, United States
Tongji University	2021.9 – 2025.7
Bachelor of Engineering, Software Engineering (GPA: 92.3/100)	Shanghai, China
University of California, Berkeley	2023.8 – 2023.12
Exchange Student (GPA: 4.0/4.0)	California, United States

Publications

Research Interests: MoE, AI Application, HCI

- Less is MoE: Trimming Experts in Domain-Specialist Language Models** [In submission to EMNLP 2026]
Haoze He*, **Xinkai Zou***, Xuan Jiang, Xingyuan Ding, Ao Qu, Billy Li, Heather Miller (* Equal Contribution)
- Preserving Long-Tailed Expert Information in Mixture-of-Experts Tuning** [COLM 2026]
Haoze He, Xingyuan Ding, Xuan Jiang, **Xinkai Zou**, Alex Cheng, Yibo Zhao, Juncheng Billy Li, Heather Miller
- Simulating Organized Group Behavior: New Framework, Benchmark, and Analysis** [COLM 2026]
Xinkai Zou*, Yiming Huang*, Zhuohang Wu, Jian Sha, Nan Huang, Longfei Yun, Jingbo Shang, Letian Peng (* Equal Contribution)
- Towards Generalizable Context-aware Anomaly Detection: A Large-scale Benchmark in Cloud Environments** [In submission to COLM 2026]
Xinkai Zou, Xuan Jiang, Ruikai Huang, Haoze He, Parv Kapoor, Hongrui Wu, Yibo Wang, Jian Sha, Xiongbo Shi, Zixun Huang, Jinhua Zhao
- Kairotask: Probing the Bridge Between Vague Intents and Spatiotemporal Contexts** [CHI 2026 Posters]
Jiachen Du, Yuanhao Zhang, Hengyu Jin, **Xinkai Zou**, Junwei Zhu, Xinyi Fu
- The Social Dynamics of Voice Cloning: Trust, Privacy, and Ethical Tensions When Sharing Your AI Voice Replica** [CSCW 2025 Posters]
Jiachen Du, Hanyu Huang, **Xinkai Zou**, Shuzi Yin, Bingjie Gao, Xinyi Fu
- Emotional Support Originating from Dialogue: Empowering Older Adults' Self-Tracking of Sleep-Related Daytime Factors** [UbiComp/ISWC 2025 Posters]
Jiachen Du, **Xinkai Zou**, Liwen He, Shuzi Yin, Bingjie Gao, Wenjing Deng, Xinyi Fu, Haipeng Mi
- TaskWise: Enhancing Cognitive Performance in Task Management through Interactive Detail Enrichment** [UbiComp/ISWC 2025 Posters]
Jiachen Du, Bingjie Gao, Shuzi Yin, **Xinkai Zou**, Wenjing Deng, Xinyi Fu
- SAFEFLOW: A Principled Protocol for Trustworthy and Transactional Autonomous Agent Systems**
Peiran Li*, **Xinkai Zou***, Zhuohang Wu, Ruifeng Li, Shuo Xing, Hanwen Zheng, Zhikai Hu, Yuping Wang, Haoxi Li, Qin Yuan, Yingmo Zhang, Zhengzhong Tu (* Equal Contribution)
- Goal2Story: A Multi-Agent Fleet based on Privately Enabled sLLMs for Impacting Mapping on Requirements Elicitation**
Xinkai Zou, Yan Liu, Xiongbo Shi, Chen Yang

Reviewer Service: COLM2026, CUI2026

Projects

Gen-AI Tool - Boston Consulting Group (BCG), Shanghai Office	2024.7 - 2025.2
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- Core Contributor Shanghai, China
- Project Design: Joined the design of technical architecture, system views and framework for the Gen-AI project, through communicating about the requirements with internal consultants as the tech leader
 - Gen-AI tool: Implemented solutions for basic dialogue and long document parsing tasks, while achieving text generation, document comprehension, and knowledge reasoning functionalities
 - Project development: Developed user monitor page with charts of usage and established scheduled task with cronjob

Tesla 2023.12 - 2024.5

- Data Science Intern Shanghai, China
- Optimized fast charging model: Incorporated trillions of discrete charging data into cycles and reduced the charging time error rate from 20% to 6% by updating the model from 1D to 2D through the incorporation of temperature factors
 - Enhanced 3rd-party charging station data: Obtained 10,000+ 3rd-party charging stations through data clustering of discrete charging location coordinates and visualized them on the map through Baidu Maps API
 - Automatic data process workflow: Improved performance in company business and SQL capabilities collaborating with other engineers by implementing cloud-based private deployment of LLM (Baichuan-13B) using Amazon SageMaker

Tongji - MIT City Science Lab (MIT Media Lab) 2023.12 - 2024.9

- Research Intern & Core Contributor – SoCity Dao Group Remote
- Green Commute: Incentivized green commute by quantifying travel carbon behaviors and combined decentralized carbon token issuance with software development and design, as well as an LSTM-based motion classifier
 - 100-Pilot Experiment: Recruited over 100 participants in the Boston area to conduct a large-scale experiment on the product of Green Commute App, collecting user feedback and performing analysis for debugging and adjustment
 - Data collection App: Developed and deployed a mobile App for geolocation data with motion classification label collection using Expo with EAS service on App Store and Google Store for internal distribution. See more details on <https://www.media.mit.edu/projects/society-dao/overview/>

Work Experience

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| • TikTok. Inc - <i>Software Developer Intern (Infra)</i> | 2026.6 – Present |
| • UC, San Diego, United States - <i>Research Assistant</i> | 2025.10 – Present |
| • Tsinghua University, China - <i>Research Assistant (HCI, AI Agent)</i> | 2024.5 – 2025.6 |
| • Tongji-MIT City Science Lab - <i>Research Assistant (Green Commute & SoCity DAO)</i> | 2023.12 – 2024.9 |
| • Tesla - <i>Data Scientist Intern</i> | 2023.12 – 2024.5 |
| • Tongji University, China - <i>Research Assistant (AI4SE)</i> | 2023.7 – 2024.5 |

Honors & Awards

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- Tongji University Undergraduate Outstanding Student Scholarship
 - Tongji University Student of the Year
 - Tongji University First-class Exchange Scholarship
 - WestLake University AI Summer School Scholarship